

I should also mention that the cmf Watch Pro's haptic intensity felt somewhat dull. This shouldn't be a problem for most people; the watch's notifications and alerts catch your attention most of the time. But if you're someone who uses their smartwatch as a morning alarm, you would find the cmf's vibrations to be on the gentler side of things. There is an audio alarm, though, that could make up for this drawback.

APP UX/UI

Having gone through multiple smartwatches in my search for something that stands out, I do think that having a well-designed companion app does improve the overall experience of the smartwatch. For an empirical mind, it's important to have detailed data that's efficiently presented; equally easy to both pore over and glance at. Simply put: a smartwatch's app should sport a clean design and easily accessible data.

To this end, the cmf Watch App is slick and neatly designed, following Nothing's now recognisable dot-matrix aesthetic. The app's elements are in shades of white and grey, with a dash of orange to highlight important bits of information. Users who prefer a dark UI may find themselves disappointed, but you can't disregard the app's look and feel. It's beautifully minimalist and very intuitive to use.

And yet, the attempt at staying minimalist occasionally takes away from a few features that people may consider important. For example, when sleep tracking, one can see when they have woken up during the night, but the app doesn't let you see exactly what time you've been awake. Which is important for people tracking their sleep patterns and trying to figure out what's disturbing their sleep. Similarly, when checking historical data, there isn't a convenient way to jump to a date. One needs to manually tap their way back day by day to get there – storage of historical data does seem to be negated by the sheer inconvenience of getting your hands on it.



SHOULD YOU BUY IT?

That's the loaded question, isn't it? Looking at the budget smartwatch market today, I wouldn't say that buying the cmf Watch Pro is the smartest choice. The brand may take another iteration or two to really crack it (if history is a good judge of patterns) but as of now, it's not there yet.

Based on the reactions to the watch that we've been seeing online, most of the reviewers who are really praising the watch as a breakthrough for its price tag operate in markets where most 'budget' smartwatches available find themselves in higher-priced segments. Maybe I'm over-analysing here, though. It's entirely possible that some people are just easily enthralled.

Don't get me wrong, here in India, the budget smartwatch segment has its share of underwhelming performers. However, when you're spoiled for choice, the law of probability says that you would undoubtedly find a larger share of diamonds in the rough. And it doesn't really help the brand that its first budget smartwatch is priced a couple of grand higher than most of its competition.

Tl;dr? Having weighed its features and performance, if you're looking for a budget smartwatch that does a good job tracking your fitness and looking smart on your wrist, we'd be more comfortable directing you to something like the Hammer Conquer or the Redmi Watch 3

Active over the cmf Watch Pro – at least in the Indian market.

VERDICT

To summarise: the cumbersome (yet sturdy) strap design, broad bezels and thick body could be a somewhat polarising design aesthetic for users. Additionally, the cmf app – while slick-looking, in Nothing's traditional minimalist style – seems to sacrifice some practical detail for the sake of minimalism. The overall performance of the Watch Pro is also strictly mediocre, for the most part. All in all, the cmf Watch Pro feels like an open beta prototype device, rather than a finished product. It's a decent smartwatch on a budget, but considering its competition, it still leaves a lot to be desired. Nothing to write home about, really.

–Prakrit Dhondiyal

SPECIFICATIONS

Dimensions: 46.9 x 39.87 x 12.89 mm (w/o strap) | 261.2 x 39.9 x 12.9 mm (with strap) | Weight: 30.4 g (w/o strap) | 47 g (with strap) | Watch frame material: Aluminum alloy | Screen: 1.96" (4.98 cm) AMOLED | 332ppi | Battery: 340mAh | 13 days of typical use | Sensors: Accelerometer, Heart rate & Blood Oxygen Saturation sensor | Bluetooth version: Bluetooth 5.3 | Compatibility: Supports iOS 13 and above, Android 8.0 and above | Satellite positioning systems: GPS/GLONASS/Galileo/QZSS/Beidou | Water & Dust Resistance Rating: IP68

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